

Reaching for the Stars.

Company	Spaceship	Services
SpaceX	Falcon 9, Dragon, and Starship that is under development for longer voyages	Low-earth orbit. Trips to space station, the moon and Mars to start later
Blue Origin	New Shepard and New Glenn; these can be used for both human space flight and to deliver cargo, while Blue Moon is under development for flights to the moon	Low-earth orbit
Virgin Galactic	VMS Eve is a mothership tasked with bringing VSS Unity, a reusable suborbital spaceship to release altitude from where it goes to LEO	Low-earth orbit
Space Adventures	Tie up with Russian space agency Roscosmos to take passengers on a Soyuz capsule	Has conducted all missions of the nine non-professionals who have travelled to ISS

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Galactic), and Jeff Bezos (Blue Origin) offer a range of space-related services—from satellite launches and cargo delivery to ferrying crew members to the ISS. These advances have also enabled private operators to let wealthy people either book a seat on a spaceship or even book the whole spaceship and build the itinerary per their choice, like with Maezawa and the dearMoon mission.

These firms that are at the frontier of taking civilians—who can pay the eye-watering sums required for a ticket (as high as \$50 million)—to space have already completed several such missions in the past few years. And more are in the pipeline with far more ambitious plans. For instance, SpaceX's Founder and CEO Elon Musk has talked about

his company's plans to land people not just on the moon but also on Mars by 2026.

So, what is fuelling this new space race to the moon, Mars, and beyond? Industry operators say it is the irresistible thrill of doing something out of the ordinary—like leaving the surface of the flying ball of rock we call home and watching it spin from a vantage point only available to a select few—that is spurring demand. “The experience offers 10-12 minutes of space exploration, featuring weightlessness, the sensation of being an astronaut, and an awe-inspiring view of our planet from a vantage point reaching approximately 360,000 feet (110 km) above the Earth's surface,” says Raaghav Belavadi, Founder and CEO of Bengaluru-based luxury services platform Hype Luxury.

PACKING FOR THE TRIP

Preparing for a trip to space is not as gruelling for non-professionals as it is for a professional astronaut. But the training required to make you space travel-ready does put you through the wringer, lit-